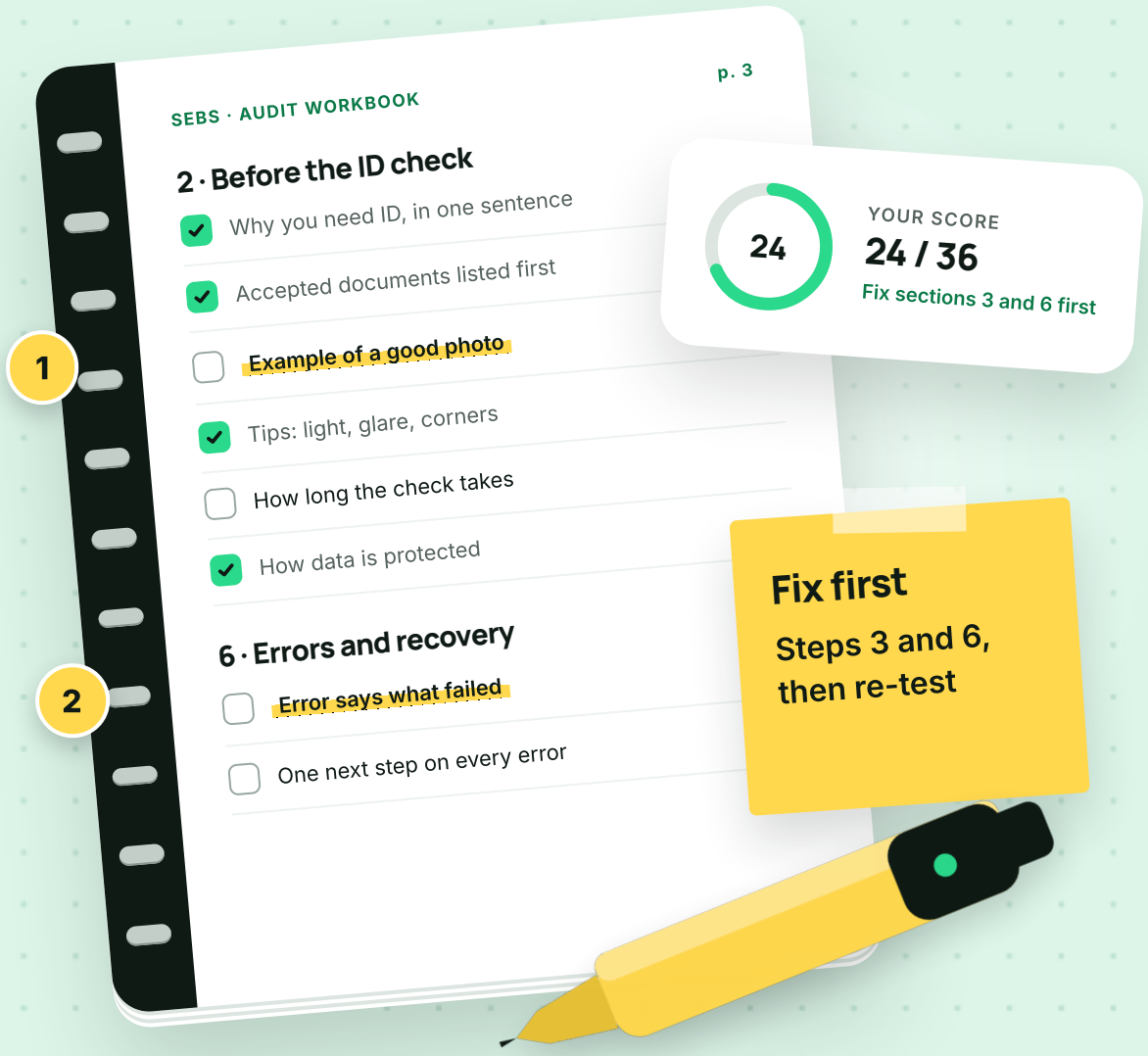
sebs.

1 Free audit checklist

FOR FINTECH, KYC AND SAAS TEAMS

Onboarding & KYC UX audit checklist

Find the exact step where users quit, using the same checks I run on client audits.



36 checks

6 steps of the flow

30 minutes

Muhammad Haseeb
Product designer, KYC & identity verification
sebsuxstudio.com

HOW TO USE IT

Go through your own signup as a new user

Every check you can't tick is a step where people are likely to give up. Most teams find their biggest leak in the first 15 minutes.

1

Use a phone

Most ID checks happen on mobile. Use a fresh email and a real document.

2

Tick as you go

Only tick a check if it is true for a first-time user, not for your team.

3

Count and fix

Add up your score on page 6. Fix the sections marked "Fix first".

The 6 sections, in the order people meet them

1	2 · Fix first	3 · Fix first	4	5	6 · Fix first
Signup and account	Before the ID check	During capture	Selfie and liveness	Waiting and results	Errors and recovery

What it's built on

NN/g usability heuristics, WCAG 2.2 AA accessibility, GOV.UK Design System guidance on forms and error messages, and two years of designing KYC flows.

What it doesn't change

This checklist covers UX, not legal compliance. Your KYC and AML checks stay exactly as they are. The goal is to make the steps around them clear.

The 3 mistakes I find most often

CHECK 09

No example photo

People don't know what a good photo looks like, so they guess, fail and retry.

CHECK 31

"Something went wrong"

The error gives no reason and no next step, so people give up.

CHECK 34

No way out

After two failed tries there is only a support form. The user is gone.

Checks 01–12

THE CHECKLIST

1 Signup and account

The first ask decides whether people start at all.

- [ ] 01 The first screen says, in one line, what people get after signing up.
- [ ] 02 You ask only for what the next step needs: email first, the rest later.
- [ ] 03 People can look around before they have to create an account.
- [ ] 04 Password rules are shown before typing, not after an error.
- [ ] 05 A progress indicator shows how many steps are left (“Step 2 of 4”).
- [ ] 06 Progress is saved if someone leaves and comes back.

2 Before the ID check FIX FIRST

Most failed uploads start with a missing explanation.

- [ ] 07 You explain why you need ID in one plain sentence.
- [ ] 08 Accepted documents are listed before the camera opens.
- [ ] 09 You show an example of a good photo.
- [ ] 10 You give 2–3 tips: good light, no glare, all four corners visible.
- [ ] 11 You say how long the check takes (“about 2 minutes”).
- [ ] 12 You say how the data is protected, close to the upload button.

THE CHECKLIST

3 During capture FIX FIRST

People need feedback while they hold the camera, not after.

- [ ] 13 The camera frame shows exactly where the document goes.
- [ ] 14 Live feedback says what is wrong (“Too dark”, “Move closer”).
- [ ] 15 The photo is taken automatically when it is good, or the button is easy to reach.
- [ ] 16 People can review the photo before sending it.
- [ ] 17 People can upload a file instead if the camera does not work.
- [ ] 18 Every field, button and camera prompt has a label a screen reader can read.

4 Selfie and liveness

This is where trust and patience run out fastest.

- [ ] 19 You explain what the selfie is for before it starts.
- [ ] 20 Instructions are short and shown one at a time.
- [ ] 21 Guidance on glasses, hats and light comes before the check, not after a failure.
- [ ] 22 Text meets 4.5:1 contrast and tap targets are at least 44 × 44 px.
- [ ] 23 Motion or liveness prompts are large and easy to follow.
- [ ] 24 There is a clear option for people who cannot complete it.

THE CHECKLIST

5 Waiting and results

Silence after submitting feels like failure.

- [ ] 25 People know their submission was received.
- [ ] 26 You say how long the review takes.
- [ ] 27 People can leave the screen without losing their place.
- [ ] 28 You notify them by email or push when there is a result.
- [ ] 29 Approval leads straight to a first useful action, not an empty screen.
- [ ] 30 “Pending” never looks like an error.

6 Errors, rejections and recovery FIX FIRST

A dead end loses the user for good.

- [ ] 31 Every error says what failed (“Your name doesn’t match your ID”).
- [ ] 32 Every error gives one next step.
- [ ] 33 Progress is kept after an error; nobody starts over.
- [ ] 34 After 2 failed tries, you offer another route: a different document, a person, or later.
- [ ] 35 Rejections give a reason in plain words, not codes.
- [ ] 36 Support is reachable from the error screen itself.

YOUR SCORE

Count your ticks

My score: _____ / 36

30–36	**Strong.** Your flow does the basics well. Look at your analytics for smaller leaks between steps.
20–29	**You're losing users at specific steps.** Start with sections 3 and 6: capture feedback and error recovery.
0–19	**Onboarding is likely your biggest growth problem.** Fix sections 2, 3 and 6 before spending more on acquisition.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

1

Fix "Fix first"

Start with sections 2, 3 and 6. They hold most of the drop-off.

2

Re-test fresh

Ask someone who has never seen your product to sign up while you watch.

3

Measure each step

Track how many people reach each step, so you know the fix worked.

Want a second pair of eyes on your flow?

I'll audit your real signup and ID check, mark every mistake on the screen, rank them by impact and show you the fix. 5 days, $990–$2,500.

Book your audit → sebsuxstudio.com

Free 20-minute call · Reply within 24 hours

Scan to book

hello@sebsuxstudio.com linkedin.com/in/muhammad-haseeb-ux WhatsApp +92 337 2186894